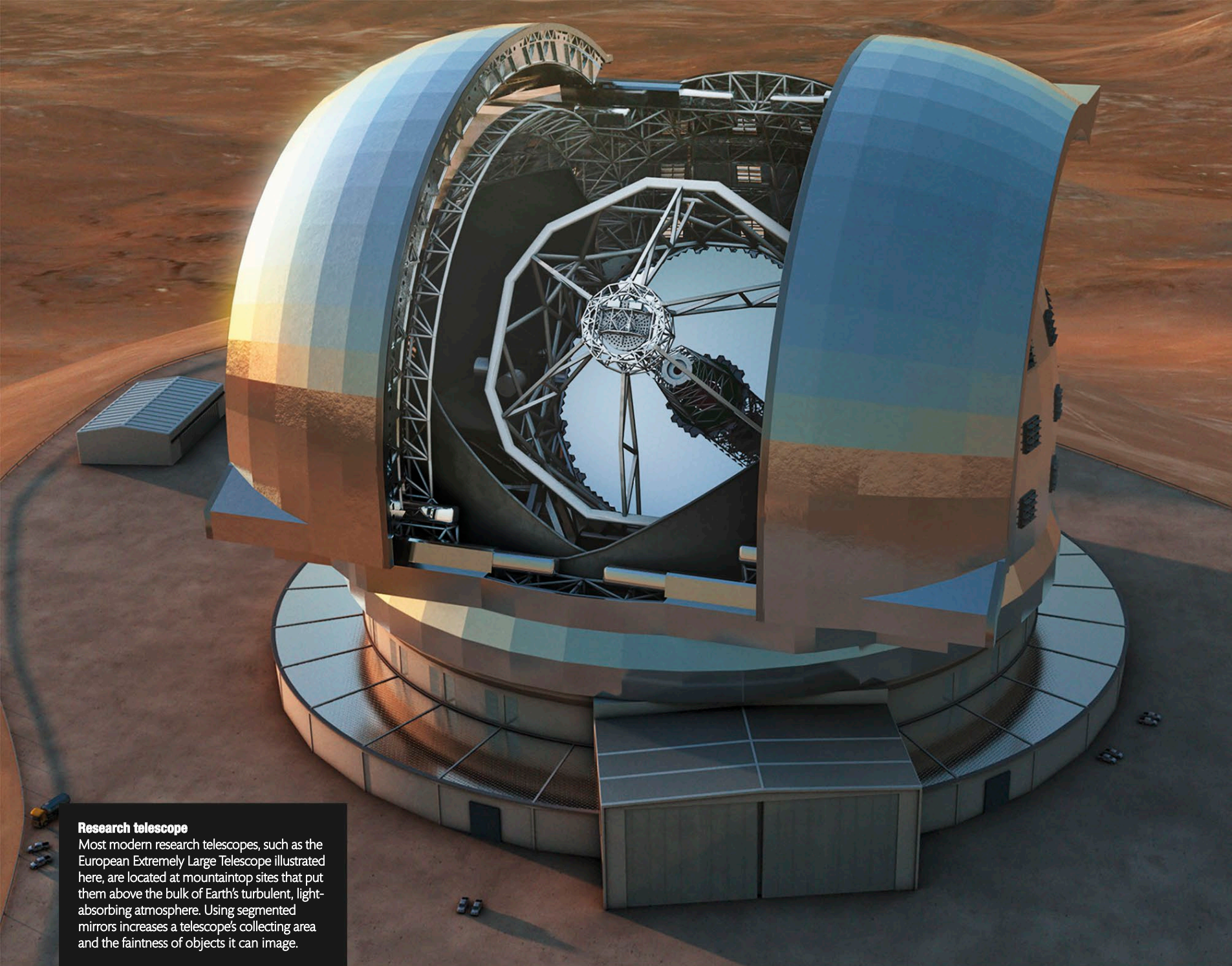




Research telescope

Most modern research telescopes, such as the European Extremely Large Telescope illustrated here, are located at mountaintop sites that put them above the bulk of Earth's turbulent, light-absorbing atmosphere. Using segmented mirrors increases a telescope's collecting area and the faintness of objects it can image.



Radio telescopes

Radio signals from space were discovered in the 1930s and are measured today using enormous bowl-shaped antennae. The much longer wavelengths of radio waves mean they need a much bigger collecting surface to resolve fine details, but radio antennae can be linked together in arrays, like this one in New Mexico.